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Movable user entry device and an access system for access control

Abstract

A movable user entry device for an access control includes an internal power source and a communication unit configured to wirelessly connect the user entry device to an external system. An access system for an access control includes an external system and at least one movable user entry device.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a Continuation of PCT International Application No. PCT/FI2020/050816, filed on Dec. 4, 2020, which is hereby expressly incorporated by reference into the present application.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The invention concerns in general the technical field of access control. Especially the invention concerns user entry devices for access control.

BACKGROUND

(2) Typically, buildings and/or elevators may comprise an access control system for controlling access of users into the building and/or into at least one elevator car of the elevator. Typically, the access control system of the building or elevator comprises at least one user entry device, e.g. a gate device, for providing access only for authorized users, i.e. identified users with an access, via the at least one gate device. The at least one gate device is fixedly installed to a desired location.

SUMMARY

(3) The following presents a simplified summary in order to provide basic understanding of some aspects of various invention embodiments. The summary is not an extensive overview of the invention. It is neither intended to identify key or critical elements of the invention nor to delineate the scope of the invention. The following summary merely presents some concepts of the invention in a simplified form as a prelude to a more detailed description of exemplifying embodiments of the invention.

(4) An objective of the invention is to present a movable user entry device and an access system for access control. Another objective of the invention is that the movable user entry device and the access system for access control enable substantially free placement of the movable user entry device.

(5) The objectives of the invention are reached by a movable user entry device and an access system as defined by the respective independent claims.

(6) According to a first aspect, a movable user entry device for an access control is provided, wherein the movable user entry device comprises: an internal power source, and a communication unit configured to wirelessly connect the user entry device to an external system.

(7) The movable user entry device may further comprise an internal access database comprising access control related data and/or the movable user entry device may be configured to obtain the access control related data from an external access database.

(8) The access control related data may be updated after the user entry device is moved.

(9) The wireless connection between the user entry device and the external system may be based on at least one of the following wireless communication technologies: a wireless local area network (WLAN), a wireless personal area network (PAN), and/or a cellular network.

(10) The movable user entry device may be configured to perform a pairing procedure with the external system to provide the wireless connection, when the wireless connection is based on the wireless personal area network.

(11) Alternatively or in addition, the wireless connection between the user entry device and the external system may be implemented via a cloud server.

(12) The movable user entry device may be configured to: determine location data representing a current location of the user entry device, obtain the location data from the external system, and/or obtain the location data as a user input.

(13) The determination of the location data may be based on a wireless indoor positioning technology.

(14) Alternatively or in addition, the movable user entry device may further comprise a motor

configured to move the user entry device.

(15) Moreover, the movable user entry device may further comprise a remote-control unit configured to remotely control the movement of the user entry device.

(16) Alternatively or in addition, the movable user entry device may further comprise at least one imaging device configured to obtain temperature data of users accessing via the user entry device.

(17) Alternatively or in addition, the movable user entry device may further comprise at least one imaging device configured to obtain identification data for facial recognition-based access control via the user entry device.

(18) The user entry device may be a physical gate device or a sensor-based user entry device.

(19) The external system may be at least one of an elevator system, an escalator system, an access control system, and a building related system.

(20) According to a second aspect, an access system for an access control is provided, wherein the access system comprises: an external system and at least one movable user entry device as described above.

(21) Various exemplifying and non-limiting embodiments of the invention both as to constructions and to methods of operation, together with additional objects and advantages thereof, will be best understood from the following description of specific exemplifying and non-limiting embodiments when read in connection with the accompanying drawings.

(22) The verbs “to comprise” and “to include” are used in this document as open limitations that neither exclude nor require the existence of unrecited features. The features recited in dependent claims are mutually freely combinable unless otherwise explicitly stated. Furthermore, it is to be understood that the use of “a” or “an”, i.e. a singular form, throughout this document does not exclude a plurality.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF FIGURES

(1) The embodiments of the invention are illustrated by way of example, and not by way of limitation, in the figures of the accompanying drawings.

(2) FIGS. 1A and 1B illustrate schematically examples of a movable user entry device according to the invention.

(3) FIGS. 2A-2C illustrate schematically examples of an access system according to the invention.

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates schematically another example of an access system according to the invention.

(5) FIG. 4 illustrates schematically yet another example of an access system according to the invention.

(6) FIG. 5 illustrates schematically an example of components of a movable user entry device according to the invention.

(7) FIG. 6 schematically illustrates an example of components of an external system according to the invention.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EXEMPLIFYING EMBODIMENTS

(8) FIGS. 1A and 1B illustrate schematically an example of a movable user entry device **102** according to the invention. FIG. 1A illustrates a front view of the example movable user entry device **102**. FIG. 1B illustrates a top view of the example movable user entry device **102**, i.e. a view from above the movable user entry device **102**. The movable user entry device **102** may refer to any point of access, e.g. a passage, through which a user has to pass through and in which a user access may be restricted depending on whether the user is identified or not and whether the identified user has an access via the user entry device **102** or not. The movable user entry device **102** may be used for access control for allowing access only for authorized users, i.e. identified users with an access, via the movable entry device **102** as will be described later in this application.

From now on throughout this application the term “user entry device” is used for the movable user entry device **102**, and the user entry device **102** discussed throughout this application is movable. The user entry device **102** may be a physical gate device, e.g. a turnstile, an access gate, or a security gate; or a sensor-based user entry device. In the example of FIGS. **1A** and **1B** the user entry device **102** is a physical gate device, e.g. a turnstile.

(9) The physical gate device may comprise a frame structure **108** forming a passage for the users to access via the user entry device **102**. The frame structure **108** may comprise e.g. two vertical structures, e.g. columns, as illustrated in the example of FIGS. **1A** and **1B**. The sensor-based user entry device does not comprise a physical frame forming the passage for the users to access via the user entry device **102**, but the passage may be formed by one or more entities of the user entry device **102**, e.g. by arranging the one or more entities of the user entry device **102** to an existing structure, e.g. to a door frame, any other frame, and/or a ceiling.

(10) The user entry device **102** may comprise one or more gate related devices for the access control. At least some of the one or more gate related devices of the user entry device **102** will be discussed next.

(11) The user entry device **102** may comprise at least one restriction device **104a**, **104b** configured to restrict access via the user entry device **102**. The at least one restriction device **104a**, **104b** may comprise at least one physical restriction device **104a** configured to provide a physical access restriction for an unidentified user and/or an identified user without an access via the user entry device **102**. Some non-limiting examples of the at least one physical restriction device may comprise, a door, a panel, a barrier, etc. Alternatively or in addition, the at least one restriction device **104a**, **104b** may comprise at least one alert device **104b** configured to provide an alert indicating an unidentified user and/or an identified user without an access via the user entry device **102**. The alert may be a visual and/or audible alert. In the example of FIGS. **1A** and **1B** the at least one restriction device **104a**, **104b** comprises a physical restriction device, i.e. doors, **104a** configured to provide the physical restriction and an alert device **104b** configured to provide the visual and/or audible alert.

(12) The user entry device **102** may further comprise at least one user identification device **106** configured to provide identification data for an access control via access control device **102**. The obtained identification data may be provided to a control unit **500** of the user entry device **102** (for sake of clarity the control unit **500** is not shown in FIGS. **1A** and **1B**), which may be configured to define whether a user is allowed to access the user entry device **102** or not based on the obtained identification data and prestored access control related data. The obtained identification data may be compared to the prestored access control related data in order to identify the user. The access control related data may further comprise data relating to the identified users having the access via the user entry device **102** in order to determine the identified users with the access via the user entry device **102** and the identified users without the access via the user entry device **102**. In other words, the control unit **500** of the user entry device **102** may be configured to define whether the identification data relates to an identified user with an access via a user entry device **102**, an identified user without an access via the user entry device **102**, or an unidentified user. The at least one user identification device **106** may comprise at least one of biometric identification device(s), optical identification device(s) (e.g. at least one imaging device **570** as will be describe later), radio frequency based identification device(s), and magnetic identification device(s) or any other type of user identification device(s).

(13) The user entry device **102** may be configured to allow only the access of the identified users with an access via the user entry device **102**. The user entry device **102** may be configured to be by default at a state allowing an unrestricted access via the user entry device **102**. In other words, the user entry device **102** may be maintained at the state allowing the unrestricted access via the user entry device **102** and if the identification data relates to an unidentified user and/or a user without an access via the user entry device **102**, the control unit **500** of the access control device **102** may

be configured to control the at least one restriction device **104a**, **104b** to prevent, i.e. restrict, the access via the user entry device **102**, e.g. by closing the at least one physical restriction device **104a** and/or providing an alert via the at least one alert device **104b**, wherein the alert indicates a restricted access. Alternatively, the user entry device **102** may be by default at a state preventing, i.e. restricting, the access of the users via the user entry device **102**. In other words, the user entry device **102** may be maintained in a closed state and if the identification data relates to an identified user with an access via the user entry device **102**, the control unit **500** of the user entry device **102** may be configured to control the at least one restriction device **104a**, **104b** to provide the access via the user entry device **102** e.g. by opening the at least one physical restriction device **104a** and/or providing an alert via the at least one alert device **104b**, wherein the alert indicates an allowed access.

(14) In addition to the one or more gate related devices, the user entry device **102** according to the invention further comprises at least one internal power source **550** and a communication unit **530** (for sake of clarity the internal power source **550** and the communication unit **530** are not shown in FIGS. **1A** and **1B**). The at least one internal power source **550** may be configured to power one or more entities, devices, and/or units of the user entry device **102**. The at least one internal power source **550** may comprise, e.g. at least one battery and/or at least one fuel cell. Preferably, the at least one internal power source **550** may be rechargeable. The user entry device **102** may further comprise one or more further entities or units. At least some of the one or more further entities, devices and/or units will be described later in this application.

(15) FIG. **2A** illustrates schematically an example of an access system **200** according to the invention. The access system **200** comprises an external system **210** and at least one user entry device **102** according to the invention. The communication unit **530** of the user entry device **102** is configured to wirelessly connect **220** the user entry device **102** to the external system **210**. The wireless connection **220** enables at least data transfer between the user entry device **102** and the external system **210**. The external system **210** may be at least one of an elevator system, an escalator system, an access control system, and a building related system. The implementation of the external system **210** may be done as a stand-alone entity or as a distributed environment between a plurality of stand-alone entities, such as a plurality of servers providing distributed resource. Alternatively or in addition, the implementation of the entities of the external system **210** may be done as local entities and/or cloudbased entities. The wireless connection **220** between the user entry device **102** and the external system **210** may be based on at least one of the following wireless communication technologies: a wireless local area network (WLAN), e.g. Wi-Fi; a wireless personal area network (PAN), e.g. Bluetooth (BT), or Zigbee; a cellular network, e.g. 4G or 5G; and/or any other known wireless communication technologies. The wireless communication technologies may be divided e.g. in local wireless connection technologies (e.g. WLAN and/or PAN) and mobile wireless connection technologies (e.g. cellular networks). The communication unit **530** of the user entry device **102** may be configured to provide the wireless connection **220** by using at least one local wireless connection technology and/or at least one mobile wireless connection technology. Alternatively or in addition, the wireless connection **220** between the user entry device **102** and the external system **210** may be implemented via a cloud server **230**. FIG. **2B** illustrates an example of the access system **200**, wherein the user entry device **102** may be wirelessly connected **220** to the external system **210** by using at least one wireless connection technology (i.e. a wireless connection **220** illustrated with the dashed arrow in FIG. **2B**) and/or the user entry device **102** may be wirelessly connected **220** to the external system **210** via the cloud server **230** by using at least one wireless connection technology (i.e. a wireless connection **220** illustrated with the solid line arrows in FIG. **2B**).

(16) The wireless connection **220** to the external system **210** and the internal power source **550** enable the movability of the user entry device **102**. The movability of the user entry device **102** and/or the movable user entry device **102** means that the physical location of the user entry device

102 may be freely defined and/or changed, i.e. relocated, from one location to another location, as long as the wireless connection **220** to the external system **210** may be provided, i.e. established. Thus, the physical location of the user entry device **102** is not fixed to any particular predefined location. The frame structure **108** of the user entry device **102** may preferably be substantially light to ease the movability of the user entry device **102**. For example, materials of the different entities of the user entry device **102** and/or the frame structure **108**, may be selected so that the frame structure **108** of the user entry device **102** may be substantially light. The movability of the user entry device **102** enables that the user entry device **102** may be substantially freely located and/or moved. This enables substantially free placement of the user entry device **102** into an environment, e.g. a building environment as long as the wireless connection **220** to the external system **210** may be provided, i.e. established. The user entry device **102** may even be located outside from a building as long as the wireless connection **220** to the external system **210** may be established. The user entry device **102** may be manually movable. Alternatively or in addition, the user entry device **102** may be motorized as will be described later in this application.

(17) FIG. 2C illustrates schematically an example of the movability of the user entry device **102**. In the example of FIG. 2C the movability of the at least one user entry device **102** is exemplified with one user entry device **102**, but the invention is not limited to that and the access system **200** according to the invention may also comprise more than one user entry device **102**, each user entry device **102** being movable. In the example of FIG. 2C dashed arrows **240** illustrate the movement of the user entry device **102** and dashed outlines of the user entry device **102** illustrate non-limiting example locations of the user entry device **102** after the movement.

(18) According to an example embodiment of the invention, the user entry device **102** may comprise an internal, i.e. a local, access database **302a** comprising the access control related data. Alternatively or in addition, the user entry device **102** may be configured to obtain the access control related data from an external access database **302b**, **302c**, e.g. a cloud database **302b** a database **302c** of the external system **210** and/or any other external database. The term “external access database” means throughout this application an access database residing external to the user entry device **102**. The user entry device **102** may be wirelessly connected to the cloud database **302b** to obtain the access control related data. FIG. 3 illustrates schematically an example of the access system **200** with example options for the access database **302a**, **302b**, **302c** implementations. The access control related data may be updated after the user entry device **102** is moved to another location, i.e. is relocated. The updating of the access control related data enables that the identified users with access via the user entry device **102** may vary depending on the location of the user entry device **102**. The update of the access control related data may be provided remotely via the wireless connection. Alternatively or in addition, the update of the access control related data may be provided locally, i.e. manually, by a user, e.g. building manager or operator, for example by inputting the updated access control related data to the user entry device **102** as a user input via a user interface **540** of the user entry device **102** and/or via a data storage device, e.g. a USB memory stick or any other data storage device.

(19) For example, if the wireless connection **220** is based on the wireless local area network, the communication unit **530** of the user entry device **102** may be configured to provide the wireless connection **220** to the external system **210**, e.g. an access point of the external system **210**, when the communication unit **530** detects the wireless local area network of the external system **210**. The wireless connection **220** based on the wireless local area network may be provided, when the user entry device **102** resides within a range of the wireless local area network of the external system **210**.

(20) Alternatively or in addition, for example when the wireless connection **220** is based on the wireless personal area network, e.g. Bluetooth, the user entry device **102** may be configured to perform a pairing procedure with the external system **210** to provide, i.e. establish, the wireless connection **220**. The pairing procedure may be performed e.g. when the user entry device **102** is

connected first time to the external system **210**. In addition, the pairing procedure may be performed after the location of the user entry device **10** is changed, i.e. the user entry device **102** is moved to another location. The wireless connection **220** based on the wireless personal area network may be provided, when the user entry device **102** resides within a range of the personal area network of the external system **210**. The pairing procedure between a user entry device **102** and the external system **210** may comprise transferring device data related to said user entry device **102** between the user entry device **102** and the external system **210**. Each user entry device of the at least user entry device **102** may have a gate device specific, i.e. unique, identifier (ID). The device data may comprise for example the gate device specific ID; location data representing current physical location of the user entry device **102**; distance data representing distance between the user entry device **102** and at least one predefined location; and/or any other device specific data. The pairing process between the user entry device **102** and the external system **210** may be performed, e.g. during powering up the user entry device **102**, by transferring the device data from the user entry device **102** to the external unit **210** and linking the device specific ID of the user entry device **102** to the external unit **210** using the wireless connection **220**. Alternatively or in addition, the pairing procedure between the user entry device **102** and the external system **210** may be performed manually by a user, e.g. building manager or operator, by entering, i.e. inputting, the device data related to said user entry device **102** to the user entry device **102** and/or to the external system **210**.

(21) According to an example embodiment of the invention, the user entry device **102** may be configured to determine location data representing a current (physical) location of the user entry device **102**. The user entry device **102** may determine the location data e.g. based on a wireless indoor positioning technology. The wireless indoor positioning technology may for example be, but is not limited to, wireless local area network-based technology, e.g. Wi-Fi; Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE)-based technology, e.g. BLE beacons; or any other wireless indoor positioning technology. The user entry device **102** may further be configured to transfer the location data to the external system **210** so that the external system **210** is aware of the current location of the user entry device **102**. The user entry device **102** may be configured to determine the location data each time, when the location of the user entry device **102** is changed, i.e. the user entry device **102** has been relocated or the location of the user entry device **102** has been moved.

(22) Alternatively or in addition, according to an example embodiment of the invention, the user entry device **102** may be configured to obtain the location data from the external system **210** so that the user entry device **102** is aware of its current location. The external system **210** may be configured to determine the location data e.g. based on a wireless indoor positioning technology. The wireless indoor positioning technology may for example be, but is not limited to, wireless local area network-based technology, e.g. Wi-Fi; Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE)-based technology, e.g. BLE beacons; or any other wireless indoor positioning technology. The user entry device **102** may be configured to obtain the location data from the external system **210** each time, when the location of the user entry device **102** is changed, i.e. the user entry device **102** has been relocated or the location of the user entry device **102** has been moved.

(23) Alternatively or in addition, according to an example embodiment of the invention, the user entry device **102** may be configured to obtain the location data manually, as a user input, e.g. by a building manager or operator, for example by inputting or entering the location data to the user entry device **102** via a user interface **540** of the user entry device **102** and/or via a data storage device, e.g. a USB memory stick or any other data storage device. The user entry device **102** may further be configured to transfer the location data to external system **210** so that the user entry device **102** is aware of the current location of the user entry device **102**. The location data may be obtained manually each time, when the location of the user entry device **102** is changed, i.e. the user entry device **102** has been relocated or the location of the user entry device **102** has been moved.

(24) The location data of the user entry device **102** determined and/or obtained according to one or

more of the above discussed examples may be used e.g. in the updating of the access control related data after the user entry device **102** is moved to another location, i.e. is relocated. This enables that the access control related data corresponding to the current location of the user entry device **102** may be used, because as discussed above the identified users with access via the user entry device **102** may vary depending on the location of the user entry device **102**.

(25) Alternatively or in addition, according to an exemplifying embodiment of the invention, the user entry device **102** may be motorized, i.e. the user entry device **102** may comprise a motor **560**, e.g. an electric motor, to move the user entry device **102**. The user entry device **102** may further comprise wheels (for sake of clarity not shown in Figures). The motor **560** may be configured to move the user entry device **102** by powering the wheels. The wheels may be arranged under, i.e. below, the user entry device **102** to facilitate the movability of the at user entry device **102**.

(26) According to an exemplifying embodiment of the invention, the user entry device **102** may further comprise a remote-control unit **450** for remotely control the movement and/or location of the user entry device **102**. The remote-control unit **450** enables that the user entry device **102** may be remotely guided to a desired location. FIG. **4** illustrates schematically an example of the access system **200** according to the invention, wherein the user entry device **102** further comprises the remote-control unit **450**. The remote-control unit **450** may comprise a user interface for receiving user input from a user **460** of the remote-control unit **450**, e.g. a building manager or building operator. In response to receiving the user input via the user interface the remote-control unit **450** may be configured to control remotely the movement and/or location of the user entry device **102** by generating one or more control signals to the user entry device **102**. The generated one or more control signals may comprise one or more instructions indicating the movement of the user entry device **102** and/or a new location of the user entry device **102**. In response to receiving the one or more control signals from the remote-control unit **450** the user entry device **102** may be configured to control the motor **560** to move the user entry device **102**. The remote-control unit **450** may be communicatively coupled to the user entry device **102**. The communication between the remote-control unit **450** and the user entry device **102** may be based on one or more known wireless communication technologies, for example, but is not limited to, local area network, Bluetooth, or Application Programming Interface (API). Each user entry device **102** may comprise own dedicated remote control unit **450** to remotely control the movement and/or location of said user entry device **102** or one remote control unit **450** may be used to remotely control the movement and/or location two or more user entry devices **102**, if the access system **200** comprises more than one user entry device **102**.

(27) Alternatively or in addition, according to an exemplifying embodiment of the invention the at least one user identification device **106** of the user entry device **102** may comprise at least one imaging device **570** configured to obtain identification data for facial recognition-based access control via the user entry device **102**. The at least one imaging device **570** may be an internal device of the user entry device **102**, e.g. integrated into the user entry device **102**, or an external device arranged, e.g. mounted, to the user entry device **102**. The obtained identification data may be provided to the control unit **108** of the user entry device **102**, which is configured to define whether a user is allowed to access the user entry device **102** or not as discussed above.

(28) Alternatively or in addition, according to an exemplifying embodiment of the invention, the user entry device **102** may comprise at least one imaging device **570** configured to obtain temperature data of users accessing via the user entry device **102**. Preferably, the at least one imaging device **570** configured to obtain the temperature data may be the same at least one imaging device **570** configured to obtain the identification data. An abnormal temperature of a user may indicate that the user has, e.g. a virus, infection. In response to a detection of an abnormal temperature in the temperature data, the at user entry device **102** may be configured to provide a user feedback e.g. by means of the at least one alert device **104b**, prevent the access of a possible infected user, e.g. by means of the at least one physical restriction device **104a**, and/or generate an

indication of a possibly infected user accessing via the user entry device **102** to the external system **210**. The user feedback may be e.g. visual or audio feedback for the user to indicate the detection of the abnormal temperature of said user. The indication generated to the external system **210** may be used e.g. to inform the building manager or operator, and/or trace the possibly infected user. Alternatively or in addition, the temperature data obtained by the at least one imaging device **570** may be provided e.g. to health care authorities for gathering health data. The movability of the user entry device **102** enables that the user entry device **102** may be substantially quickly installed at a desired location to observe the temperature of people, e.g. during viral outbreaks. The at least one imaging device **570** configured to obtain the recognition data and/or temperature data may further be used to gather data to be used in optimization of a people flow.

(29) FIG. 5 schematically illustrates an example of components of the user entry device **102** according to the invention. The user entry device **102** may comprise the control unit **500**, the at least one internal power source **550**, and the gate related devices as described above. The control unit **500** may comprise a processing unit **510** comprising one or more processors, a memory unit **520** comprising one or more memories, the communication unit **530** comprising one or more communication devices, and possibly a user interface (UI) unit **540**. The gate related devices may comprise, but are not limited to, the motor **560**, the at least one identification device **106**, possibly the at least one imaging device **570**, the at least one restriction device **104a**, **104b**, and/or any other gate related device. The memory unit **520** may store portions of computer program code **525** and any other data (e.g. the internal access database **302a**), and the processing unit **510** may cause the user entry device **102** to operate as described by executing at least some portions of the computer program code **525** stored in the memory unit **520**. The communication unit **530** may be based on at least one known wireless communication technologies, in order to exchange pieces of information as described earlier. The communication unit **530** provides an interface for communication with any external unit, such as the external system **210**, the cloud server **230**, the external access database **302b**, **302c**, the remote-control unit **450**, and/or any other external systems/units. The communication unit **530** may comprise one or more communication devices, e.g. one or more radio transceivers, one or more antennas, etc. The user interface **540** may comprise I/O devices, such as buttons, keyboard, touch screen, microphone, loudspeaker, display and so on, for receiving user input and outputting information.

(30) FIG. 6 schematically illustrates an example of components of the external system **210** according to the invention. The external system **210** may comprise a control unit **600** and the system related devices **605**. The control unit **600** may be configured to control at least partly the operation of the external system **210**. For example, if the external system **210** is an elevator system, the control unit **600** may be an elevator control unit or an elevator control system. The control unit **600** may comprise a processing unit **610** comprising one or more processors, a memory unit **620** comprising one or more memories, the communication unit **630** comprising one or more communication devices, and possibly a user interface (UI) unit **640**. The system related devices **605** may comprise, but are not limited to, one or more devices, entities, and/or systems related to the external system **210**. For example, if the external system **210** is an elevator system, the system related devices **605** may comprise e.g. at least one elevator car arranged to travel along a respective at least one elevator shaft between a plurality of landings, a hoisting system, a safety circuit, an elevator door system, user interface devices, and/or any other elevator related devices and/or systems. The memory unit **620** may store portions of computer program code **625** and any other data (e.g. the external access database **302c**), and the processing unit **610** may cause the external system **210** to operate as described by executing at least some portions of the computer program code **625** stored in the memory unit **620**. The communication unit **630** may be based on at least one known wireless communication technologies, in order to exchange pieces of information as described earlier. The communication unit **630** provides an interface for communication with any external unit, such as the at least one user entry device **102**, the cloud server **230**, and/or any other

external systems/units. The communication unit **630** may comprise one or more communication devices, e.g. one or more radio transceivers, one or more antennas, etc. The user interface **640** may comprise I/O devices, such as buttons, keyboard, touch screen, microphone, loudspeaker, display and so on, for receiving user input and outputting information.

(31) At least some of the embodiments of the user entry device **102** and the access system **200** according to the invention as defined above enables that the at least one user entry device **102** may be substantially freely located. This in turn enables flexible layout of the environment, in which the user entry device **102** and/or the access system **200** according to the invention is implemented, e.g. the layout of an elevator lobby area. The layout of the environment may be adjusted based on current need. Alternatively or in addition, the location of the user entry device **102** may be adjusted based on current need. Alternatively or in addition, the user entry device **102** and/or the access system **200** according to the invention may be exploited in planning of a people flow, e.g. the people flow of a building or the elevator system, before determining the final location of the at least user entry device **102**.

(32) The specific examples provided in the description given above should not be construed as limiting the applicability and/or the interpretation of the appended claims. Lists and groups of examples provided in the description given above are not exhaustive unless otherwise explicitly stated.

Claims

1. A movable user entry device for an access control, wherein the movable user entry device comprises: access control related data for identifying users having access via the movable user entry device, wherein the movable user entry device is configured to allow only access of the users identified by the access control related data via the movable user entry device; an internal power source; and a communication unit configured to wirelessly connect the user entry device to an external system, wherein the moveable use entry device is configured to: perform a pairing procedure by transferring a device data of the movable user entry device to an external system, and linking the device data of the movable user entry device to an access database of the external system; determine location data representing a current location of the movable user entry device; transfer the location data representing the current location of the user entry device to the external system; and update the access control related data after the user entry device is relocated from a previous location to the current location according to the linking of the movable user entry device with the access database of the external system and the determined location data, such that users that are identified by the updated access control related data to have access via the movable user entry device are associated with the new location of the movable user entry device, and after the access control related data is updated, the movable user entry device is configured to allow only access of the users identified by the updated access control related data via the movable user entry device.
2. The movable user entry device according to claim 1, further comprising an internal access database comprising the access control related data and/or the user entry device is configured to obtain the access control related data from an external access database.
3. The movable user entry device according to claim 2, wherein the wireless connection between the user entry device and the external system is implemented via a cloud server.
4. The movable user entry device according to claim 1, wherein the wireless connection between the user entry device and the external system is based on at least one of the following wireless communication technologies: a wireless local area network (WLAN), a wireless personal area network (PAN), and/or a cellular network.
5. The movable user entry device according to claim 4, configured to perform the pairing procedure with the external system to provide the wireless connection, when the wireless connection is based

on the wireless personal area network.

6. The movable user entry device according to claim 4, wherein the wireless connection between the user entry device and the external system is implemented via a cloud server.
 7. The movable user entry device according to claim 1, wherein the wireless connection between the user entry device and the external system is implemented via a cloud server.
 8. The movable user entry device according to claim 1, configured to: determine location data representing a current location of the user entry device; obtain the location data from the external system; and/or obtain the location data as a user input.
 9. The movable user entry device according to claim 8, wherein the determination of the location data is based on a wireless indoor positioning technology.
 10. The movable user entry device according to claim 1, further comprising a motor configured to move the user entry device.
 11. The movable user entry device according to claim 10, further comprising a remote-control unit configured to remotely control the movement of the user entry device.
 12. The movable user entry device according to claim 1, further comprising at least one imaging device configured to obtain temperature data of users accessing via the user entry device.
 13. The movable user entry device according to claim 1, further comprising at least one imaging device configured to obtain identification data for facial recognition-based access control via the user entry device.
 14. The movable user entry device according to claim 1, wherein the user entry device is a physical gate device or a sensor-based user entry device.
 15. The movable user entry device according to claim 1, wherein the external system is at least one of an elevator system, an escalator system, an access control system, and a building related system.
 16. An access system for an access control, wherein the access system comprises: an external system; and at least one movable user entry device comprising: access control related data for identifying users having access via the at least one movable user entry device, wherein the at least one movable user entry device is configured to allow only access of the users identified by the access control related data via the at least one movable user entry device; an internal power source; and a communication unit configured to wirelessly connect the at least one moveable user entry device to an external system, wherein the at least one moveable use entry device is configured to: perform a pairing procedure by transferring a device data of the at least one movable user entry device to an external system, and linking the device data of the at least one movable user entry device to an access database of the external system; determine location data representing a current location of the at least one movable user entry device; transfer the location data representing the current location of the at least one movable user entry device to the external system; and update the access control related data after the at least one movable user entry device is relocated from a previous location to the current location according to the linking of the at least one movable user entry device with the access database of the external system and the determined location data, such that users that are identified by the updated access control related data to have access via the at least one movable user entry device are associated with the new location of the at least one movable user entry device, and after the access control related data is updated, the at least one movable user entry device is configured to allow only access of the users identified by the updated access control related data via the at least one movable user entry device.
 17. The movable user entry device according to claim 2, wherein the wireless connection between the user entry device and the external system is based on at least one of the following wireless communication technologies: a wireless local area network (WLAN), a wireless personal area network (PAN), and/or a cellular network.
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